Toolbox Talk: TB#06

Forklift Safety Rules

Forklifts can become very dangerous if operated by a reckless or incompetent operator. All operators should attend forklift training from an approved service provider prior to being allowed to operate a forklift. Forklift accidents tend to be very serious, involving both personal injury and damage to property. These accidents can be avoided if operators use some common sense and follow safe operating procedures. Do not operate a forklift until you have been properly competent and authorized to do so by your supervisor.

Basic Forklift Safety Practices:

Here are a few common safety rules to follow during forklift operation:

1. Use the forklift seat belt to secure yourself, it will keep you secured in the seat in the unplanned event of a tip over.
2. A parked forklift should have the forks flat on the floor with the controls set to neutral and with the parking brake set.
3. Unattended forklifts should be parked at the designated parking area, lower the fork, engage the handbrake, switch off the ignition and remove the ignition key.
4. When operating the forklift on inclines, the load should always be on the uphill side of the incline. Drive forward going up the incline. Drive backward going down the incline.
5. When traveling without a load on the forks, keep the forks approximately four to six inches off the floor.
6. Never allow anyone to walk underneath a raised load.
7. Stop at all blind corners to check for other traffic in the area. This includes other forklifts and pedestrians. Honk your horn and look before you proceed.
8. If carrying a tall load that blocks your forward vision, drive in reverse and turn your head so you can see where you are going.
9. If operating around other forklifts maintain a slower speed between forklifts and never attempt passing.
10. Never drive a forklift up to the back of a person who is unaware that the forklift is behind them.